City of Saint Paul

Meeting Minutes

City Council

City Hall and Court House
15 West Kellogg Boulevard
Council Chambers - 3rd Floor
651-266-8560

Council President Rebecca Noecker
Vice President HwaJeong Kim
Councilmember Anika Bowie
Councilmember Molly Coleman
Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson
Councilmember Saura Jost
Councilmember Nelsie Yang

Wednesday, February 4, 2026 **3:30 PM** **Council Chambers - 3rd Floor**

ROLL CALL

Meeting started at 3:30 PM

Present 5 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost and Councilmember Molly Coleman

Absent 2 - Councilmember HwaJeong Kim and Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson

CONSENT AGENDA
Items listed under the Consent Agenda will be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. If discussion on an item is desired, the item will be removed from the Consent Agenda for separate consideration.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Consent Agenda adopted

Yea: 5 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 2 - Councilmember Kim and Councilmember Johnson

1 RES 26-120 Authorizing the Department of Parks and Recreation to apply for grant funds, in an amount of up to $800,000, from the Minnesota Department of Cannabis Management's CanRenew Community Restoration grant for Right Track, the City's Youth Employment Program for SFY 2027.

Adopted

2 RES 26-122 Accepting the gift of travel expenses from the Knight Foundation for Library Director Maureen Hartman to attend the Knight Foundation Library Leaders Convening and Knight Media Forum from February 10 - February 13, 2026 in Miami, Florida.

Adopted

3 RES 26-149 Approving the use or non-use of a Project Labor Agreement on Department of Parks and Recreation construction projects for the first half of 2026.

Adopted

4 RES 26-168 Supporting the study of new passenger rail service between Saint Paul and Fargo/Moorhead and Saint Paul and Kansas City, Missouri.

Adopted

5 RES 26-192 Approving the Proposed Issuance of Conduit Health Care Revenue Bonds by the Housing and Redevelopment Authority for the Episcopal Homes Obligated Group (The Willows Project), 80 Mackubin Street, under Minnesota Statutes, Sections 469.152 through 469.1655 (District 8 Ward 1).

Adopted

FOR DISCUSSION

SUSPENSION ITEMS

RES 26-231 Approving the appointment of Kamaria Kassim as the Director of Human Resources effective February 9, 2026.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Kamaria Kassim was sworn in.

Adopted

Yea: 5 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 2 - Councilmember Kim and Councilmember Johnson

ROLL CALL

Present 6 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember HwaJeong Kim, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost and Councilmember Molly Coleman

Absent 1 - Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson

RES 26-253 Calling on the State of Minnesota and Governor Walz to enact an energy and gas shutoff moratorium to keep Minnesota families safe and protect them from ICE.

Councilmember Yang spoke in favor, read from the resolution, and moved approval.

Mike Hirabayashi and Jean Comstock from Unidos St. Paul gave remarks.

Councilmember Jost spoke in favor.

Adopted as amended

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

ORDINANCES

An ordinance is a city law enacted by the City Council. It is read at three separate council meetings and becomes effective after passage by the Council and 30 days after publication in the Saint Paul Pioneer Press. Public hearings on ordinances are generally held at the second reading.

Final Adoption

6 Ord 26-4 Granting the application of Baillon Company to rezone four (4) I1 light industrial parcels to B5 central business-service.

Councilmember Kim moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

7 Ord 26-5 Adding Chapter 268 to the Legislative Code to prohibit law enforcement staging operations on city-owned properties and limit access to non-public City spaces.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Councilmembers Kim, Yang, Bowie, Jost, and Noecker gave remarks.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

First Reading

8 Ord 26-8 Amending Section 86.01(a) of the Saint Paul Administrative Code to Authorize up to Three (3) Assistants to the Mayor to Execute Certain Contracts Made in

the Name of the City of Saint Paul and Authorized by the City Council and Further Amending Section 86.01 (a) to Increase the Dollar Value Amount for Contracts Executed by Designees.

Dan Gilchrist, Assistant City Attorney, gave a staff report.

Laid over to February 11, 2026 for Second Reading

SUSPENSION ITEM

Ord 26-7 Adding Chapter 268B to the Legislative Code to require law enforcement officers to conduct law enforcement operations without a mask or facial covering unless certain exceptions apply.

Tim Greenfield, City Council Chief Policy Officer, gave a staff report.

Councilmembers Yang, Bowie, Coleman, Kim, and Noecker spoke in favor.

Laid over to February 11, 2026 for Second Reading

PUBLIC HEARINGS

Live testimony is limited to two minutes for each person. See below for optional ways to testify.

9 Ord 26-6 Adding Chapter 268A to the Legislative Code to require law enforcement officers performing law enforcement duties to visibly display identification on the outermost layer of their uniform.

6 people spoke during the public hearing.

Council President Noecker moved to close the public hearing and lay over for one week.

Councilmember Yang moved reconsideration after Item 10. Approved 6-0.

Councilmember Kim moved Version 2. Approved 6-0.

Dan Stahley, Assistant City Attorney, spoke to the amendment.

Noecker moved to close the public hearing and lay over for one week.

Amended and laid over to February 11, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

10 RES PH 26-28 Authorizing the City to accept a $500,000 grant from the State to pay for Technology Rich Space improvements to the Rondo Community Library; authorizing the execution of a grant agreement related thereto (which includes indemnification language); authorizing the appropriate City officials to record a declaration related to the grant agreement on the Rondo Community Library

property; and amending SPPL's 2026 financing and spending plans.

Councilmember Jost moved to close the public hearing. Approved 6-0.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

11 RES PH 26-13 Ratifying the assessment for Repair of Sanitary Sewer Line on Private Properties. (File No. SWRP2503, Assessment No. 253002)

Councilmember Bowie moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

12 RES PH 26-14 Ratifying the assessment for Replacement of Lead Water Service Line on Private Properties. (File No. 2502LDSRP, Assessment No. 254001)

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

13 RES PH 26-16 Amending the financing and spending plan in the Department of Parks and Recreation Grant Fund, in the amount of $35,000, to reflect grant funds received from the Minnesota State Arts Board (MSAB) to support the St. Paul Get Down program (and authorization to enter into a grant agreement detailing the requirements of said grant, which include an indemnification clause).

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

14 RES PH 26-18 Approving the 2026 - 2027 Capital Improvement Budget Committee Capital Maintenance Funding recommendations, and amending the 2026 Capital Improvement Budget to allocate funding for capital maintenance projects to the appropriate departments, as recommended by the committee.

Councilmember Kim moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

15 RES PH 26-21 Authorizing the Extension of the Terms of the Minnesota Department of Employment and Economic Development Grant under the Minnesota Investment Fund (MIF) Program for ForwardEdge ASIC LLC.

Daniela Lorenz from the Department of Planning and Economic Development gave a staff report.

27 people spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Coleman moved to close the public hearing. Approved 6-0.

Coleman moved to lay over for one week.

Councilmembers Yang, Bowie, and Kim spoke against a layover.

Coleman withdrew her motion to lay over.

Council President Noecker asked for clarification. Lorenz addressed Noecker's question.

Kim moved denial. ("Aye" votes are recorded as "Nay" votes for the purposes of legislative management software functionality.)

Yang and Kim spoke in favor of denial.

Denied

Yea: 0

Nay: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

16 RES PH 26-22 Authorizing the Police Department to amend the 2026 Grant Fund for the sub-grant received from Ramsey County for the Violent Crime Enforcement Team (VCET).

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

17 RES PH 26-29 Amending the financing and spending plans in the Fire Department in the amount of $20,000 for a grant from Ramsey County Public Health to purchase a LUCAS device.

Councilmember Jost moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

18 RES PH 26-30 Amending the financing and spending plans in the Fire Department in the amount of $115,393 for a contribution received from the Minnesota Board of Firefighter Training and Education (MBFTE) to pay for training for firefighters.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

19 RES PH 26-31 Authorizing the Office of Financial Empowerment to apply for and accept a $165,000 grant from the McKnight Foundation to support operational costs for its shared ownership initiative and amending the 2026 budget for the Office of Financial Empowerment.

Councilmember Kim moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

20 RES PH 26-37 Establishing the Festivals and Events Security Credit.

Councilmembers discussed potential amendments which would be considered the following week.

7 people spoke during the public hearing.

Council President Noecker moved to close the public hearing and lay over for one week.

Public Hearing closed and laid over to February 11, 2026.

21 PH 26-4 Public hearing on grievances about federal immigration operations.

14 people spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Kim gave remarks and moved to continue the public hearing for one week.

Public hearing continued to February 11, 2026

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

LEGISLATIVE HEARING DISCUSSION ITEM

SUSPENSION ITEM

RLH VO 26-7 Appeal of Minister Scarlet Rose to a Fire Inspection Report, which includes condemnation, at 787 HOWELL STREET NORTH.

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer, gave a staff report and stated her recommendation.

Councilmember Coleman moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

LEGISLATIVE HEARING CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will receive a combined public hearing and be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. Items may be removed from the Consent Agenda for a separate public hearing and discussion if desired.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

22 RLH TA 25-294 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 427 AURORA AVENUE. (File No. J2522R4, Assessment No. 258582)

Adopted as amended (assessment deleted)

23 RLH TA 25-413 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 862 CLEAR AVENUE. (File No. J2601TW1, Assessment No. 268703) (Amend to delete)

Adopted as amended (assessment deleted)

24 RLH TA 25-119 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 263 CURTICE STREET WEST. (File No. J2507T1, Assessment No. 258537)

Adopted as amended (assessment reduced)

25 RLH RR 25-28 Ordering the rehabilitation or razing and removal of the structures at 430 DALE STREET NORTH within fifteen (15) days after the October 22, 2025, City Council Public Hearing. (Amend to remove within 15 days)

Adopted as amended (remove within 15 days)

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Johnson

26 RLH TA 25-416 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 913 EARL STREET. (File No. J2601TW2, Assessment No. 268704) (Amend to delete)

Adopted as amended (assessment deleted)

27 RLH SAO 26-5 Appeal of Danny Ballard to a Summary Abatement Order at 120 FLANDRAU PLACE.

Adopted

28 RLH TA 25-111 Amending Council File RLH TA 24-472 to Continue the Public Hearing for the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 1055 FOURTH STREET EAST adopted by Council on February 12, 2025. (File No. J2505R, Assessment No. 258508)

Adopted as amended (assessment deleted)

29 RLH SAO 25-69 Making finding on the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 2016

FREMONT AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 25-55.

Adopted as amended (nuisance abated)

30 RLH SAO 26-6 Appeal of Mark Puchala to a Vehicle Abatement Order at 2016 FREMONT AVENUE.

Adopted

31 RLH FCO 26-2 Appeal of Gomaa Elzamel to a Fire Inspection Report at 1090 LOEB STREET.

Adopted

32 RLH TA 25-391 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 933 WOODBRIDGE STREET. (File No. J2601R4, Assessment No. 268605) (Amend to delete)

Adopted as amended (assessment deleted)

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting ended at 7:35 PM

City Council meetings are open for in person attendance, but the public may also comment on public hearing items in writing. Any comments and materials submitted by 12:00 pm of the day before the meeting will be attached to the public record and available for review by the City Council. Comments may be submitted as follows:

Written public comment on public hearing items can be submitted to Contact-Council@ci.stpaul.mn.us or CouncilHearing@ci.stpaul.mn.us. Live testimony will be taken in person in the Council Chambers.

Council Meeting Information
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Web
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